AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
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Section 18A approved: 9 October 2026
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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

# M&G Investments Southern Africa × ASCO

## Youth Learning and Community Participation Hubs

**Requested CSI investment:** R100,000

**Proposed implementation area:** Cape Flats, Western Cape, South Africa (proposed; subject to ASCO's verified delivery capacity and M&G approval)

**Prepared:** October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

## Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **M&G Investments Southern Africa** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Youth Learning and Community Participation Hubs**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Youth Learning and Community Participation Hubs in Cape Flats, Western Cape, South Africa (proposed; subject to ASCO's verified delivery capacity and M&G approval), benefiting Proposed: under-resourced secondary-school learners and unemployed or out-of-school youth in the selected Cape Flats community, with educators, caregivers and community mentors benefiting indirectly; final numbers and age range should be confirmed through a local needs assessment. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with M&G Investments Southern Africa's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

**What ASCO is requesting**
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

**What the funding would enable**
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

## About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

**Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu**
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# The proposed project

**Project title**
Youth Learning and Community Participation Hubs

**Implementation period**
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

**Location**
Cape Flats, Western Cape, South Africa (proposed; subject to ASCO's verified delivery capacity and M&G approval)

**Target beneficiaries**
Proposed: under-resourced secondary-school learners and unemployed or out-of-school youth in the selected Cape Flats community, with educators, caregivers and community mentors benefiting indirectly; final numbers and age range should be confirmed through a local needs assessment.

## Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: establish or support 2 community learning and youth-participation hubs over 12 months.
- Proposed: reach 150 learners/youth with structured literacy, numeracy, study-support, life-skills and civic-participation sessions.
- Proposed: deliver at least 24 facilitated youth workshops and 4 community-led action projects, with youth involved in design and implementation.
- Proposed: train 15 volunteer educators or community mentors in facilitation, safeguarding and referral practices.
- Proposed: provide learning materials and basic monitoring, with baseline/endline attendance and learning-participation reporting to the funder.

## Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

# Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

## Why M&G Investments Southern Africa?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

### Verified company context

- M&G Investments Southern Africa states that its CSI programme prioritises education, skills development and holistic support for under-resourced communities across South Africa and Namibia.
- Its CSI brochure says education is central to the strategy and links the approach to inclusive, quality education and active societal participation.
- The brochure describes three initiative types: corporate CSI partner initiatives with registered non-profit organisations, staff community initiatives, and Living CSI activities.
- The brochure says the CSI Committee identifies aligned projects and partners, oversees the CSI budget and staff funding process, and monitors initiative impact across diverse regions in South Africa and Namibia.
- Official 2025 examples include support for learners and youth through LEAP schools in Gauteng and the Western Cape, science education in Langa, Cape Town, literacy and numeracy in the Cape Flats, early childhood development in the Valley of 1000 Hills, and youth development in Plettenberg Bay.
- M&G's official CSI article says its programme continues to invest in education, youth empowerment and community development through long-term partnerships and tangible interventions.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

## Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

| Budget category | Indicative amount | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Direct programme implementation | R60,000 | Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project. |
| Participant transport and access | R8,000 | Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records. |
| Safety equipment and participant welfare | R6,000 | PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements. |
| Educational and mobilisation materials | R8,000 | Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication. |
| Monitoring, evaluation and reporting | R7,000 | Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting. |
| Volunteer/project coordination | R7,000 | Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management. |
| Reasonable administration | R4,000 | Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads. |
| **Total requested CSI investment** | **R100,000** | **Equals the proposed request.** |

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

## Partnership options

**Option A — Full project funding**
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

**Option B — Partial project funding**
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

**Option C — Multi-phase partnership**
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

**In-kind or technical support**
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

## Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

## Initial contact route

No dedicated public CSI application route was found in the reviewed official materials. Contact M&G Investments Southern Africa Client Services at info@mandg.co.za or 0860 105 775 (Monday-Friday, 08:00-17:00) and ask to be routed to the CSI Committee/community investment team. ASCO may also provide its website, https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/, and phone +27 76 757 5773 in the enquiry.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

## Important conditions and open questions

- The official sources do not publish a clear open CSI application form, funding cycle, minimum/maximum grant size, or definitive eligibility checklist; the route should therefore be confirmed directly with M&G.
- M&G's stated geography is South Africa and Namibia, but ASCO's delivery location and operating track record were not provided; the suggested location is therefore provisional.
- The sources emphasise long-term partnerships with registered non-profit organisations and impact monitoring. M&G may require due diligence, governance documents, budgets, safeguarding controls, measurable outcomes and evidence of implementation capacity.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- No completed ASCO results, existing partnerships, M&G commitment, exclusivity or likelihood of funding is established by the sources.
- M&G's public examples do not establish that every education, community-development or youth activity is eligible; avoid assuming unrestricted cash, individual bursaries, sports-only activities or capital works will qualify without confirmation.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

## Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **M&G Investments Southern Africa** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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## Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.mandg.co.za/insights/articles/connecting-to-our-communities-making-a-difference-through-csi-in-2025
2. https://mandg.co.za:8082/media/vpteggvd/csi-brochure.pdf
3. https://group.mandg.com/sustainability/resilient-societies

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.